

HSBC (0005.HK/HSBA.L)

2Q26 Preview: Another robust quarter, with focus on NII guidance and wealth trends

HSBC will report 2Q26 results on 4th August; we expect the bank to deliver **underlying PBT of US\$10.2bn**, +25% yoy / +2% qoq (4% ahead of Visible Alpha Consensus Data). Quarterly growth is supported by a lower cost of credit of 40bps as we do not anticipate further overlays related to the Middle East conflict, while 1Q's elevated provisioning was also impacted by a large one-off credit-related charge. Banking NII should also increase 3% qoq, supported by slightly higher HIBOR. Offsetting this, we expect some moderation in non-banking NII following seasonally stronger 1Q trends. Beyond the quarter, investor focus is likely to remain on wealth management, particularly any updates on Chinese cross-border regulations and the potential implications for wealth inflows, the broader wealth outlook, and whether the higher rate environment drives an upward revision to NII guidance.

Key call-outs for the quarter:

- **Banking NII in focus.** We expect Banking NII to increase 3% qoq, supported by uptick in HIBOR throughout the quarter (+6bps qoq), a higher day count and continued balance sheet growth. The outlook has also become more constructive, with HIBOR rising more meaningfully towards the end of the quarter, suggesting a larger benefit in 3Q26. In addition, the higher-for-longer rate environment and steeper yield curve should remain supportive through structural hedge reinvestment and balance sheet repricing. Given the higher rate environment and the anticipation of higher for longer rates, we revise our NII forecast by +0.4%/+2%/+2% for 2026-2028E and are now 3% above VA consensus for banking NII. We expect key focus on the 2026 Banking NII guidance and potential upgrades given the stronger interest rate outlook and improving HIBOR backdrop.
- **Non-interest income is expected to remain resilient, with underlying non-banking NII of US\$7.4bn (+6% yoy / -7% qoq in 1Q26), 3% ahead of VA consensus.** We anticipate some moderation following seasonally stronger 1Q trends and a normalisation in transaction banking fees from elevated levels in 1Q. Looking ahead, investor focus will likely remain on wealth management, particularly any updates on Chinese cross-border regulations and their implications for wealth inflows, growth momentum and the broader wealth outlook. We note that 1Q26 included \$39bn in Wealth net new money (of which

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\$34bn in Asia), well ahead of the prior quarter and prior year (\$26bn in 4Q25 and \$23bn in 1Q25) — as a result, although we see solid core trends continuing, we see potential for a sequential slowdown in Q2, simply reflecting the high comp.

- **Credit costs should decline, with our forecast at 40bps versus 52bps in 1Q26.** We do not anticipate any further overlays related to the Iran conflict, while 1Q's elevated provisioning was also impacted by a large one-off credit charge that is unlikely to recur. As a result, we expect credit costs to normalise in 2Q26.
- **Capital and shareholder returns will be another key focus.** We expect HSBC to resume share buybacks this quarter following a three-quarter pause related to the HSB acquisition, as previously indicated by management. We model US\$1.5bn of share repurchases being announced with 2Q26, which should still leave the bank with a strong CET1 ratio of c.14.0% after accruals.

We raise our EPS estimates by up to 1.6% for FY26–29E, primarily reflecting a more supportive interest rate outlook, partly offset by higher opex as we anticipate increased investment in growth initiatives and technology to support revenue expansion. As a result, we raise our 12-month two-stage DDM TP for 0005.HK to HK\$181 (from HK\$165) and our TP for HSBC.L to 1,725p (from 1,700p). We maintain Buy ratings on 0005.HK and HSBC.L (on EMEA CL).

Exhibit 1: Our underlying PBT are up to 5% ahead of visible alpha consensus for 2026–2028E and 4% ahead for 2Q26E

HSBC	2Q26E				2026E				2027E				2028E			
	GS	VA	%	mn	GS	VA	%	mn	GS	VA	%	mn	GS	VA	%	mn
Banking NII	11,541	11,486	0%	55	46,769	46,424	1%	345	49,546	48,121	3%	1,425	50,996	49,740	3%	1,256
Fees and Other Income	7,357	7,165	3%	192	28,715	28,501	1%	214	30,737	30,188	2%	550	32,704	32,463	1%	241
Underlying Revenues	18,898	18,651	1%	247	75,483	74,925	1%	559	80,283	78,309	3%	1,975	83,700	82,203	2%	1,497
Significant Revenue Adjustments	0	-50	-100%	50	-501	-880	-43%	379	0	-85	-100%	85	0	-245	-100%	245
Total Revenues	18,898	18,601	2%	297	74,982	74,045	1%	938	80,283	78,224	3%	2,060	83,700	81,958	2%	1,742
Underlying Operating Expenses	-8,337	-8,444	-1%	107	-34,359	-34,344	0%	-15	-35,536	-35,294	1%	-242	-36,753	-36,292	1%	-461
Significant Cost Adjustments	-343	-239	44%	-104	-1,200	-1,032	16%	-168	-200	-751	-73%	551	-200	-800	-75%	600
Total Operating Expenses	-8,680	-8,682	0%	3	-35,559	-35,377	1%	-182	-35,736	-36,045	-1%	309	-36,953	-37,093	0%	140
Credit Costs	-1,005	-1,049	-4%	44	-4,261	-4,501	-5%	239	-3,747	-4,059	-8%	312	-3,682	-4,134	-11%	452
Operating Profit - Reported	9,213	8,870	4%	344	35,162	34,167	3%	995	40,801	38,120	7%	2,681	43,065	40,731	6%	2,333
Operating Profit - Underlying	9,556	9,158	4%	398	36,863	36,079	2%	784	41,001	38,956	5%	2,044	43,265	41,777	4%	1,488
P/L from Associates and JV	677	717	-6%	-41	2,815	2,528	11%	287	2,845	2,745	4%	100	2,902	2,742	6%	160
PBT - Reported	9,890	9,587	3%	303	37,977	36,695	3%	1,282	43,646	40,865	7%	2,781	45,967	43,473	6%	2,494
PBT - Underlying	10,233	9,876	4%	357	39,678	38,607	3%	1,071	43,846	41,702	5%	2,144	46,167	44,519	4%	1,648
Income Taxes	-2,241	-2,013	11%	-227	-8,462	-7,818	8%	-645	-9,889	-8,660	14%	-1,229	-10,415	-9,257	13%	-1,157
PAT - Reported	7,649	7,574	1%	76	29,515	28,877	2%	637	33,757	32,206	5%	1,551	35,552	34,216	4%	1,337
Minorities	-38	-31	21%	-7	-249	-145	71%	-104	-254	-125	103%	-129	-259	-115	125%	-144
Net Income - Reported	7,611	7,542	1%	69	29,266	28,732	2%	534	33,503	32,081	4%	1,422	35,293	34,101	3%	1,193
Preferred Stock	-155	-181	-14%	26	-1,198	-1,231	-3%	33	-1,198	-1,238	-3%	40	-1,198	-1,242	-4%	44
Ordinary Net Income - Reported	7,456	7,361	1%	95	28,068	27,501	2%	566	32,305	30,843	5%	1,462	34,095	32,859	4%	1,236
Per Share Data																
EPS - Basic	0.43	0.43	1%	0.01	1.64	1.63	0%	0.01	1.90	1.87	1%	0.02	2.03	2.05	-1%	-0.02
DPS - Declared	0.10	0.10	0%	0.00	0.84	0.82	2%	0.02	0.95	0.92	4%	0.03	1.02	1.00	2%	0.02
Capital (bn)																
CET1 Capital	126	127	-1%	-1	121	131	-8%	-10	129	137	-6%	-8	138	145	-5%	-7
RWAs	903	894	1%	9	921	911	1%	10	963	946	2%	18	1,004	984	2%	20
CET1 Ratio	14.0%	14.2%	-26 bps	-	13.2%	14.4%	-124 bps	-	13.4%	14.5%	-110 bps	-	13.8%	14.7%	-95 bps	-
Balance Sheet (bn)																
Total Assets	3,327	3,323	0%	4	3,382	3,359	1%	23	3,490	3,449	1%	42	3,586	3,554	1%	32
Total Equity	195	197	-1%	-2	203	204	0%	-1	213	212	0%	1	223	220	1%	2
Tangible Equity	160	162	-1%	-2	168	167	0%	1	178	175	2%	3	188	183	3%	5
Loans	1,011	1,013	0%	-2	1,031	1,028	0%	3	1,077	1,065	1%	12	1,121	1,105	1%	16
Deposits	1,805	1,804	0%	1	1,852	1,834	1%	18	1,950	1,903	2%	47	2,036	1,969	3%	67
Ratios																
Net Interest Margin				-	4.58%	4.55%	3 bps	-	4.70%	4.60%	10 bps	-	4.64%	4.58%	6 bps	-
CIR - Reported	46%	47%	-0.7 pp	-	47%	48%	-0.4 pp	-	45%	46%	-1.6 pp	-	44%	45%	-1.1 pp	-
CIR - Underlying	44%	45%	-1.2 pp	-	46%	46%	-0.3 pp	-	44%	45%	-0.8 pp	-	44%	44%	-0.2 pp	-
Cost of Risk				-	42 bps	44 bps	-2 bps	-	36 bps	39 bps	-3 bps	-	34 bps	38 bps	-5 bps	-
Effective Tax Rate - Reported	23%	21%	1.7 pp	-	22%	21%	1.0 pp	-	23%	21%	1.5 pp	-	23%	21%	1.4 pp	-
ROTE (post AT1)				-	17.1%	16.7%	0.4 pp	-	18.7%	18.0%	0.6 pp	-	18.6%	18.4%	0.2 pp	-
Loans / Deposits	56%	56%	-0.1 pp	-	56%	56%	-0.4 pp	-	55%	56%	-0.7 pp	-	55%	56%	-1.1 pp	-

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: We made changes to our NII forecast baking in higher rates offset by slightly higher opex

(US\$mn)	FY2026E		FY2027E		FY2028E		FY2029E		% change			
	Old	New	Old	New	Old	New	Old	New	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Group - Underlying basis												
Banking NII	46,592	46,769	48,627	49,546	50,018	50,996	51,441	52,527	0.4	1.9	2.0	2.1
Non-NII	28,715	28,715	30,737	30,737	32,704	32,704	34,595	34,595	0.0	-0.0	0.0	0.0
Revenue	75,307	75,483	79,364	80,283	82,722	83,700	86,036	87,123	0.2	1.2	1.2	1.3
Operating expenses	(34,359)	(34,359)	(35,390)	(35,536)	(36,451)	(36,753)	(37,545)	(37,856)	-0.0	0.4	0.8	0.8
PPP	40,948	41,125	43,975	44,748	46,271	46,947	48,491	49,267	0.4	1.8	1.5	1.6
Provision	(4,535)	(4,261)	(3,747)	(3,747)	(3,682)	(3,682)	(3,722)	(3,722)	-6.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Operating profit	36,413	36,863	40,228	41,001	42,589	43,265	44,769	45,545	1.2	1.9	1.6	1.7
Pre-tax profits	39,227	39,678	43,073	43,446	45,491	46,167	47,730	48,505	1.1	0.9	1.5	1.6
Group - Reported basis												
Revenue	74,806	74,982	79,364	80,283	82,722	83,700	86,036	87,123	0.2	1.2	1.2	1.3
Operating expenses	(35,423)	(35,559)	(35,590)	(35,736)	(36,651)	(36,953)	(37,545)	(37,856)	0.4	0.4	0.8	0.8
PPP	39,383	39,424	43,775	44,548	46,071	46,747	48,491	49,267	0.1	1.8	1.5	1.6
Provision	(4,535)	(4,261)	(3,747)	(3,747)	(3,682)	(3,682)	(3,722)	(3,722)	-6.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
credit costs (bp)	45	42	36	36	34	34	33	33	-6.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Operating profit	34,848	35,162	40,028	40,801	42,389	43,065	44,769	45,545	0.9	1.9	1.6	1.7
Pre-tax profits	37,662	37,977	42,873	43,646	45,291	45,967	47,730	48,505	0.8	1.8	1.5	1.6
Attributable profit	27,824	28,068	31,707	32,305	33,572	34,095	35,453	36,053	0.9	1.9	1.6	1.7
Stated EPS (US\$)	1.62	1.64	1.87	1.90	2.01	2.03	2.16	2.18	0.8	1.6	0.9	0.7
Underlying EPS (US\$)	1.66	1.68	1.88	1.91	2.02	2.04	2.16	2.18	0.8	1.6	0.9	0.7
DPS (US\$)	0.83	0.84	0.94	0.95	1.01	1.02	1.08	1.09	0.8	1.6	0.9	0.7

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Melissa Kuang, CFA, Chris Hallam, Benjamin Caven-Roberts, Sachin Nayar and Wayne Wang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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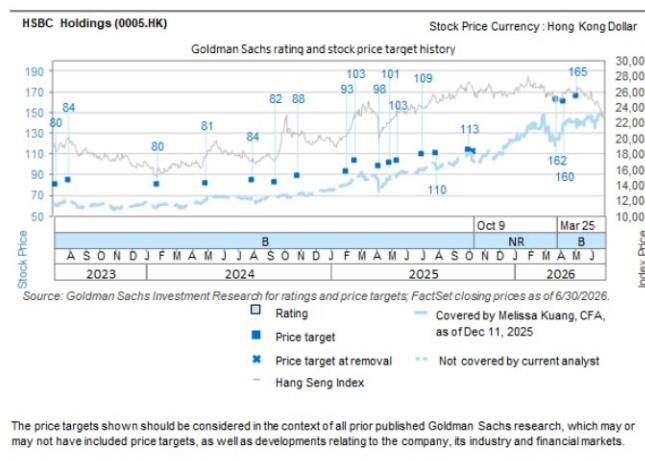
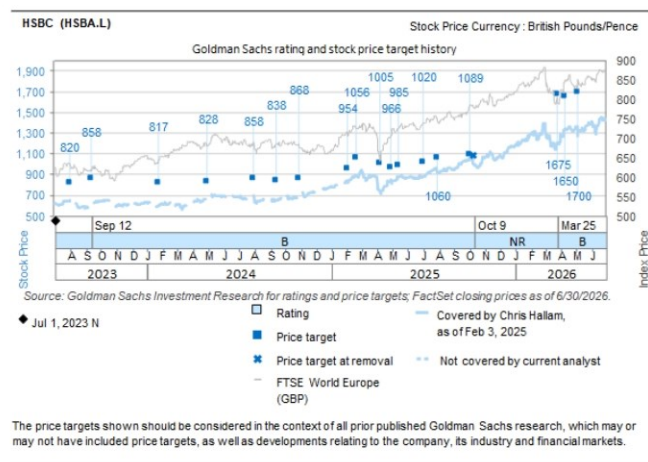
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

HSBC (HSBA.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
05-May-26	1,700	1,279.8
10-Apr-26	1,650	1,340.2
25-Mar-26	1,675	1,211.4
03-Oct-25	1,089	1,061.8
30-Jul-25	1,060	926
02-Jul-25	1,020	885.3
13-May-25	985	876.1
29-Apr-25	966	855.6
07-Apr-25	1,005	737.8
19-Feb-25	1,056	895.4
02-Feb-25	954	845.7
29-Oct-24	868	713.7
14-Sep-24	838	658.7
31-Jul-24	858	704
30-Apr-24	828	695.6
23-Jan-24	817	598.8
12-Sep-23	858	597.3
01-Aug-23	820	654.9

HSBC Holdings (0005.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
05-May-26	165.00	136.00
10-Apr-26	160.00	139.70
25-Mar-26	162.00	125.00
03-Oct-25	113.00	109.90
30-Jul-25	110.00	96.95
02-Jul-25	109.00	95.25
13-May-25	103.00	89.65
29-Apr-25	101.00	88.35
07-Apr-25	98.00	73.40
19-Feb-25	103.00	88.40
02-Feb-25	93.00	79.95
29-Oct-24	88.00	71.60
14-Sep-24	82.00	67.30
31-Jul-24	84.00	69.95
30-Apr-24	81.00	67.00
23-Jan-24	80.00	59.20
01-Aug-23	84.00	66.30

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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